

Tianhui Wu

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EDUCATION	University of Iowa, U.S. Ph.D., Political Science Expected May 2027 Dissertation: <i>"Understanding the Role of Propaganda in Shaping Corruption Perceptions in Autocracies"</i> Committee: Frederick Solt (<i>Chair</i>), Elise Pizzi, Marina Zoloznaya, Qihang Lin M.A., Political Science 2024 Sun Yat-sen University, China M.A., Political Theory 2022 Fudan University, China B.A., Political Science and Public Administration 2019
RESEARCH INTERESTS	Substantive: Comparative politics, with a regional focus on China and East Asia; authoritarian politics; political communication; corruption and governance; comparative public opinion and political behaviour. Methods: Computational social science: quantitative text analysis, natural language processing and large language models; survey and conjoint experiments; causal inference with observational panel data; time-series and cross-national survey analysis.
PUBLICATIONS	Boehmke, Frederick J., Thomas Dainty, Samantha J. DeRagon, Hyein Ko, Taylor Tokos, Tianhui Wu, and Weidong Zhang. Forthcoming. "The Use of Visualization in Political Science: A Century of Growth and the Current State." <i>PS: Political Science and Politics</i>. (Corresponding; Authors in alphabetic order) Xia, Ying and Tianhui Wu. 2024. "Building Consensus: Implementing the 'One-Shoulder' Policy in a Village with a Divided Elite Structure." <i>Journal of Sun Yat-sen University (Social Science Edition)</i>, 64(4): 155–164. (In Chinese) Xia, Ying, Tianqing Chen and Tianhui Wu. 2023. "Public Petition and Government Responsiveness: Evidence from City A." <i>Fudan Public Administration Review</i>, 27(2): 101–116. (In Chinese)
UNDER REVIEW	Wu, Tianhui. "How the Public Perceives Hidden Corruption: Opinion Leadership and Elite Cues." Wu, Tianhui, Elise Pizzi and Tracy Osborn. "Focus on Disaster: Why Attention to Hazards Appears in Party Manifestos." Pizzi, Elise, Tianhui Wu and Sara McLaughlin Mitchell. "Reducing Post-Disaster Conflict Risk Through Migrant Remittances." (Corresponding) Hu, Yue, Tianhui Wu and Wenfang Tang. "The Political Impacts of Grassroots Corruption in China and Their Mechanisms." (Corresponding; In Chinese)
WORKING PAPERS	Wu, Tianhui. "Measuring Anti-Corruption Propaganda in China's Official Media: A Text-Based Analysis of News Broadcasts." Wu, Tianhui. "When Corruption Comes Home: Own-Province Investigation Reporting and Public Perceptions in China." Wu, Tianhui. "Protest the Suppression of Protest: A Study of Emotional Mechanisms behind the 2019–2020 Hong Kong Protests."

Wu, Tianhui. “Do Elections Reduce or Reinforce Perceived Corruption? Comparative Evidence from Democracies.”

Wu, Tianhui and Caroline J. Tolbert. “State Electoral Competition, Winners and Losers, and Perceived Electoral Integrity.”

PRESENTATION	Conferences	
	Midwest Association for Public Opinion Research (MAPOR)	2026
	APSA Political Communication Pre-conference	2026
	Southern Political Science Association (SPSA)	2026
	Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)	2024–2026
	American Political Science Association (APSA)	2023–2025
	Invited Talks	
	School of Government, Sun Yat-sen University	2024
	External	
FELLOWSHIP, GRANTS AND AWARDS	Prestage-Cook Travel Award (\$500), SPSA	2026
	Travel Grant Award (\$500), Democracy & Autocracy Section, APSA	2025
	Best Paper Award, Summer Institute in Computational Social Science, Rochester	2024
	National Scholarship for Graduate Students (\$2,850), Ministry of Education, China	2021
	First Prize, 16th “Challenge Cup” National College Students’ Academic Competition, China	2019
	Internal Campus-Wide	
	Graduate College Summer Fellowship (\$5,500), University of Iowa	2026
	Graduate College Post-Comprehensive Research Fellowship (\$11,375), University of Iowa	2025
	Graduate Student Senate Travel Funds (\$320, \$300), University of Iowa	2025–2026
	Graduate & Professional Student Government Travel Grant (\$350), University of Iowa	2024
TEACHING	First Class Grant and Scholarship (\$8,570), Sun Yat-sen University	2019–2021
	Internal Department	
	Best Graduate Seminar Paper, University of Iowa	2025
	Department Summer Scholarship (\$2,000; \$5,500), University of Iowa	2023, 2025
	Travel Grant (\$500, \$1,500, \$1,350), University of Iowa	2024–2026
	Instructor	
	<i>University of Iowa</i>	
	Introduction to Comparative Politics (Undergrad; Online)	Fall 2022, Spring 2026
	Local Politics (Undergrad; Online)	Fall 2022
	Teaching Assistant	
RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	<i>University of Iowa</i>	
	Introduction to Political Analysis (Undergrad)	Spring 2023, Spring 2024
	Big Ideas: Introduction to Information, Society, and Culture (Undergrad)	Fall 2023
	Workshop Instructor	
	<i>University of Iowa</i>	
	Stata Workshop, Graduate Advanced Methods Seminar (Graduate)	Sept 2025
	Full empirical workflow, from cleaning raw data to interpreting regression output.	
	LLM Workshop: Large Language Models in Python (Faculty & Graduate)	Sept 2024
	Co-taught with Eric Ngo; Hugging Face pipelines and the OpenAI API for text classification.	
	Co-Investigator	
	Weibo Annotation Project	2026–Present
	Wrote the codebook, built the annotation application, and trained coders for a corpus of about 80,000 posts from Weibo, a major Chinese microblogging platform.	

Research Assistant

Disasters, Migration, and Violence (DMV) Lab, NSF-funded, University of Iowa 2024–2025

Worked with Professors Sara Mitchell and Elise Pizzi; built a cross-national time-series dataset on government responses to disasters.

Prof. David Greenwood-Sanchez, University of Iowa

Summer 2023, 2024

Collected Chinese policy documents on potato promotion; analysed public attitudes towards GMOs in Mexico.

Group Leader

Nine-Province Rural Survey, Fudan University

Summer 2019

Led fieldwork in three villages; fielded a paired-profile conjoint and an item-count experiment.

SERVICE

Reviewer: *Journal of Elections, Public Opinion and Parties*

Department of Political Science, University of Iowa

Advisor to first-year Ph.D. students in comparative politics

ADDITIONAL
TRAINING

University of Rochester

Summer Institute in Computational Social Science

2024

SKILLS

Technical: Python (Hugging Face, OpenAI API, scikit-learn), R, Stata, L^AT_EX, Git/GitHub

Methods: Quantitative text analysis and word-embedding measurement; large language models for classification and annotation; survey and conjoint experiments; causal inference; time-series analysis; multilevel and spatial models

Language: English (Fluent), Mandarin Chinese (Native)

REFERENCES

Frederick Solt

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